

Game Makers — Week 8

Polish, Test and Showcase 🎉

Name: _____

TODAY'S BIG IDEA

Finishing is a skill. Making something work for *you* is one thing. Making it work for someone who has never seen it before is completely different — and much harder.

THE THREE DEBUGGING RULES

Write these somewhere you'll remember them. They work on code, homework, and arguments.

1. **Say what you expected and what actually happened.** Half of all bugs are found in that one sentence.
 2. **Change one thing at a time.** If you change three things and it works, you don't know which one fixed it.
 3. **Explain it out loud.** To a friend, to a volunteer, or to a rubber duck. You'll usually spot it halfway through your own sentence.
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PLAYTEST SWAP

Move two seats to the right. Play the game in front of you for five minutes. **Don't ask the person who made it any questions** — if you're confused, that's useful information.

Fill this in for the game you played:

Game I played: _____

Two things I liked:

1. _____
2. _____

One thing that confused me:

One thing I'd add:

When you get your card back: you're not allowed to defend your game. Just read it and say thank you. If it confused them, it confused them — that's the whole point of testing.

FINISHING CHECKLIST

Work down this list. **Don't add anything new today** — polish what you have.

- [] **Title screen** with the game's name and your name
 - [] **Instructions** — one line. "Use the arrow keys to catch the mangoes."
 - [] **Score and lives** visible and easy to read
 - [] **Game over screen** showing your final score
 - [] **At least one sound**
 - [] **Credits** — your name and the club
 - [] Fixed whatever the playtest turned up
 - [] **Shared** to the club studio
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SHARING SAFELY

Your project will be visible to anyone in the world. So:

- **Don't** put your full name, your school, your address, or a photo of yourself in it.
 - Comments are public. **Be kind.** If someone is unkind to you, don't argue back — report it and tell a grown-up.
 - If you used someone else's sprite, sound or idea, **say so in your credits.** Remixing is encouraged on Scratch. Pretending it's all yours isn't.
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YOUR TWO-MINUTE DEMO

1. What your game is, in one sentence.
2. Play it for thirty seconds.
3. **The hardest bug you fixed and how you found it.** ← this is the best bit, don't skip it

My hardest bug was:

No homework. Instead — keep going!

Where to find more free projects:

- [More Scratch](#) — the natural next step
- [Further Scratch](#) — clones, My Blocks, boolean logic
- [Code Club Aotearoa](#) — hundreds of free projects
- The club studio — see what everyone else built, and remix it

Five ideas for the holidays:

1. A two-player Sky Catcher — one on arrows, one on WASD
2. A quiz about something you love

3. An animated version of a story you know
 4. A drawing app using the Pen extension
 5. A "guess the number" game where the computer picks and you guess
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 **YOU BUILT A GAME. FROM NOTHING. IN EIGHT WEEKS.**

That's a real thing that you made, and it will still work in ten years. Well done.
